



◁ Cessna 140 1946

Origin USA

Engine 85hp Continental C-85-12 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 125 mph (201km/h)

Cessna leaped ahead of the competition after WWII with this modern, all-metal, light two-seater that was economical, practical, and easy to operate; 7,664 were built and many are still flying.



△ Miles Gemini 1947

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 100 hp Blackburn Cirrus Minor air-cooled 4-cylinder inverted in-line

Top speed 145 mph (233 km/h)

Built of plastic-bonded plywood, this was the last Miles aircraft to be built in quantity, proving very popular for private transport in the immediate post-war years; 170 were built, most in 1945-46.



△ Cessna 195 Businessliner 1947

Origin USA

Engine 300 hp Jacobs R-755 air-cooled 7-cylinder radial

Top speed 185 mph (298 km/h)

Cessna's 195 prototype flew in 1945, and this speedy all-metal five-seater entered production two years later. It could also be equipped with floats. Including the military version, 1,180 were built.



△ Piper PA-12 Super Cruiser 1946

Origin USA

Engine 108-115 hp Lycoming O-235-C1 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 115 mph (185 km/h)

An update of the post-war era 1940 J5 Cub Cruiser, this three-seat PA-12 was sturdy, sleek, and approved for wheels, skis, and floats. It continues to be very popular for personal use.



△ de Havilland DH104 Dove 1947

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 380 hp Gypsy Queen air-cooled 6-cylinder inverted in-line

Top speed 230 mph (370 km/h)

One of Britain's most successful post-war civil aircraft, 542 examples of this short-haul airliner were built and some still operate commercially. This Dove was first registered to the Dunlop Rubber Company.



▷ Piper PA-17 Vagabond 1948

Origin USA

Engine 65 hp Continental A-65-8

Top speed 102 mph (164 km/h)

The PA-17 was a development of the Lycoming-engined 1947 PA-15, Piper's first post-war design. Based on the Cub with a shorter wing, it was simple, rugged, and cheap to build.